



How to install Access to Power

A simple, step-by-step guide

■ Part 1 — Install the App (cloud)

■ Part 2 — Install the Helper (PC)

⌚ About 15 minutes · 🔑 Power Apps Premium + Windows PC

Welcome! This guide walks you through getting **Access to Power** up and running. You'll do this **once**, then you can migrate as many Access databases as you want.

There are **two things** to install:

1.  **The app** — lives in Power Platform (the cloud). Everyone who uses the app shares this.
2.  **The helper** — a tiny program that lives on **your own Windows PC**. It reads the Access file off your hard drive (because a web browser can't).

 **Total time:** about 15 minutes.

 **What you need:** a Power Apps license, a Dataverse environment, and a Windows PC.

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Before you start — the checklist

Tick these off first. If anything's missing, grab it before going further.

- ☐ A **Power Apps Premium** license (the app uses Code Apps, which is a premium feature).
- ☐ A **Dataverse environment** you can create tables in. If you're not sure, ask your Power Platform admin: *"Can you give me a Dataverse environment where I'm a System Customizer or System Administrator?"*
- ☐ A **Windows PC** (Windows 10 or Windows 11). The helper does not run on Mac or Linux.
- ☐ The **64-bit Microsoft Access Database Engine**. This is a free download from Microsoft. Without it the helper can't read `.accdb` files.
 -  Search the web for "**Microsoft Access Database Engine 2016 Redistributable**" and grab the `AccessDatabaseEngine_X64.exe` version.

- ☐ The **Access to Power solution file** (`AccessToPower_x_x_x_managed.zip`) — your admin or whoever sent you here should have given you this file.
- ☐ The **helper installer zip** (`AccessToPowerHelper-x.x.x-win-x64.zip`) — same source.

? What's a Dataverse environment? Think of it like a database in the cloud where Power Apps stores its stuff. Your company probably already has one (or several). You need permission to add new tables to it.

Part 1 — Install the app (the cloud part)

This puts the **Access to Power** app into your Power Platform environment so you (and anyone else in your org) can open it from the browser.

1 Open the Power Platform Admin Center

1. Open your web browser.
2. Go to 🖱️ <https://admin.powerplatform.microsoft.com>
3. Sign in with your work account.

2 Pick your environment

1. On the left side, click **Environments**.
2. Click the **name** of the environment you want to install the app into. (If you only see one, that's the one.)

3 Import the solution

1. Near the top of the page, click **Resources** ▶ **Solutions**. *(Or click the **Solutions** tile on the environment overview.)*
2. Click the **Import solution** button at the top.
3. Click **Browse** and pick the file: `AccessToPower_x_x_x_managed.zip` (the one you got from your admin).
4. Click **Next**.
5. Click **Next** again on any "connections" page — there are none to set up here.
6. Click **Import**.
7. Wait. ⌚ This usually takes **2–5 minutes**. Don't close the tab. When it's done you'll see a green check.

✅ **You'll know it worked when** you see "Access to Power" in your solutions list with a green "Managed" tag.

4 Open the app once to set it up

1. Still in the admin center, click on the **Access to Power** solution you just imported.
2. Find the item called **Access to Power** with type **Code App** (it has a little `</>` icon).
3. Click it. A new tab opens with the app.
4. **First time only:** the browser will ask permission to use your Microsoft account. Click **Allow**.



The app is installed! Now we need the helper.

Part 2 — Install the helper (the PC part)

The helper is a small Windows program. It does **one** thing: when the app asks it to, it opens your Access file and uploads what's inside.

 **Is this safe?** Yes. The helper runs as **you**, only when **you** open the app, and only reads files **you** point it at. It doesn't run in the background. It doesn't phone home. It signs into the same Microsoft account you already use.

1 Install the Access Database Engine (one time)

 **Skip this step** if you already have Microsoft Access installed on this PC, or if your IT department has already pushed the database engine to your machine.

1. Download `AccessDatabaseEngine_X64.exe` from Microsoft's website.
2. Double-click it.
3. Click **Next**, accept the license, click **Install**.
4. When it says "Setup Completed Successfully," click **OK**.

2 Unzip the helper

1. Find the file `AccessToPowerHelper-x.x.x-win-x64.zip` (the one your admin sent you).
2. **Right-click** the zip file.
3. Choose **Extract All...** in the menu that pops up.
4. Click **Extract**. Windows makes a new folder next to the zip with the same name.
5. Open that new folder. You should see files like:
 - `AccessToPowerHelper.exe`
 - `install-helper.ps1`
 - `uninstall-helper.ps1`
 - `README.md`

3 Run the installer

This is the only part that uses a tiny bit of PowerShell. **It's just two clicks and one paste.** Follow exactly:

1. In the folder from step 2, **hold Shift** and **right-click** in some empty space inside the folder (not on a file).
2. Choose **Open in Terminal** (or **Open PowerShell window here** on older Windows). A black-or-blue window opens.
3. **Copy** the line below by clicking it once:

```
powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install-helper.ps1
```

4. **Paste** it into the black window. (Right-click in the window, or press **Ctrl+V**.)
5. Press **Enter**.

The installer prints a few lines like `==> Installing helper to ...` and finishes with:

```
Access-To-Power Helper installed successfully.
```

✓ **You'll know it worked when** you see the green "installed successfully" message. You can close the black window now.

⚠ **If you see a yellow warning** that says "Microsoft ACE OLEDB provider was not detected" — go back to Step 1 and install the Access Database Engine. The helper installed, but it won't be able to read `.accdb` files until that engine is on your PC.

4 That's it!

The helper is now installed in `C:\Users\<you>\AppData\Local\AccessToPower\Helper`. You'll **never need to open it manually** — the app will pop it open for you when it needs to read a file.

If you want to verify, look in **Settings > Apps > Installed apps** and search for "**Access-To-Power Helper**". It should be in the list.



Try it out

1. Go back to the Power Platform admin center.
2. Open the **Access to Power** app (same way as Step 4 in Part 1).
3. Click **New Migration**.
4. When the app asks you to pick your `.accdb` file, your browser may show a popup asking "Open AccessToPowerHelper?" — click **Open** (and tick "Always allow..." if you don't want to be asked again).
5. The helper opens, you sign in once with your work account, and pick your `.accdb`.



You're done! Follow the wizard from there.



Help! Something went wrong

What you see	What to do
"This page can't be displayed" when you click an <code>accesstopower://</code> link	The helper isn't installed yet, or didn't register. Re-run Part 2 ▶ Step 3 .
"Solution import failed" in Part 1	Make sure you're a System Customizer or System Administrator on that environment. If you are, try once more — sometimes the platform is just busy.
Yellow " ACE OLEDB provider was not detected " warning	Install the Microsoft Access Database Engine — see Part 2 ▶ Step 1 .
"Cannot run scripts on this system" when running the installer	You typed <code>install-helper.ps1</code> directly. Use the full command in Part 2 ▶ Step 3 — it starts with <code>powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Bypass...</code>
The helper opens but says " Sign-in failed "	Make sure you're signing in with the same account you use for Power Apps. If you have multiple work accounts, the helper picks the one Windows knows about — sign out of the wrong one in Windows Settings ▶ Accounts.
The app doesn't see the helper when I click " Scan "	Close the browser tab and reopen the app. Make sure you ran the installer (not just unzipped the folder).



How to uninstall

The helper: Open **Settings ▶ Apps ▶ Installed apps**, find **Access-To-Power Helper**, click the three dots, click **Uninstall**.

The app: In the Power Platform admin center, go to your environment ▶ **Solutions**, find **Access to Power**, click the three dots, click **Delete**.



Want to know more?

- Architecture and design: see **README.md**.

- Installer details: see **helper/installer/README.md**.
- Source code: the repo. Issues and pull requests welcome.